Channel checklist

Use this before you send a message at work. It goes with the lesson "Choosing the Right Channel at Work".

Four questions to ask

1. **Who needs it?** Think about everyone who must act on the message, and no one else.
2. **How urgent is it?** If it cannot wait, choose a channel with fast feedback.
3. **How sensitive is it?** The more personal or emotional the message, the richer the channel should be.
4. **Do you need a record?** If a decision or a detail must be documented, put it in writing.

Comparing the channels

How four common channels compare

Channel	Feedback	Record	Good for
Face to face	Immediate	None unless you write it down	Sensitive, complex or emotional conversations
Phone or video call	Fast	Usually none	Discussions that need quick back and forth
Chat	Fast	Searchable, but scattered	Quick questions and updates
Email	Slow	Kept in writing	Details, decisions and anything that must be documented

A last check

Read your message once more. Would the person who gets it know what to do, and by when?